

The Music Issue — Artometrics

The Music Issue

Charts, catalogs, and the dual books of fame — crash course for anyone who lives in the attention economy of sound.

How Long Number-One Hits Stay on Top of the Hot 100

The Billboard Hot 100 has published a number-one song every week since August 1958. In that time it has absorbed the British Invasion, the disco era, the rise of hip-hop, the collapse of the album format, and the complete restructuring of the music industry by streaming platforms. Through all of it, the same basic question persists: how long can a song stay at the top?

The file covers 1,177 distinct number-one entries — the full record of Hot 100 dominance through early 2025. The median run lasts just 2 weeks. The record holder, as of this dataset, is 19 weeks. Between those two facts sits the entire history of popular music.

Start with the scale: **1,177** number-one songs (1958–2025); **2 wks** median run length; The Beatles with the most appearances; Taylor Swift with the highest average run length among modern artists.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

1,177 Number-one songs in the dataset (1958–2025)
2 wks Median run length — most #1s are fleeting
19 wks Longest single run in the dataset

The Beatles Most appearances in the dataset — 20 number-one songs
67 yrs Span of the dataset: 1958 to 2025
Taylor Swift Highest average run length among modern artists

Data and method

The Hot 100 blends sales, radio airplay, and streaming data into a single weekly ranking. This matters for the reading: the rules of what counts have changed substantially over the decades. Before 1991, physical sales data came from store-reported estimates, not actual scan data — which made the chart easier to game. The introduction of Sound-Scan in 1991 made the chart dramatically more accurate but also temporarily destabilized it as real sales data replaced guesswork. Streaming was added in 2012, and its weight has grown continuously since.

The consequence: a long run in 1965 means something different from a long run in 2025. Streaming amplifies hits — the same song can accumulate streams 24 hours a day, seven days a week, without the bottleneck of radio scheduling. This structural change is visible in the data.

Run Length Over the Decades

Median weeks at number one per year — 1958 to 2025

The trend line tells a story in two halves. From 1958 through the 1990s, median run length drifts between 2 and 3 weeks — an era when radio play and physical sales set natural limits on how long one song could dominate. Post-2012, the median begins a slow climb as streaming rewrites the economics: a song that goes viral accumulates plays continuously, making it structurally harder for anything else to unseat it.

The highest single-year medians in the dataset cluster in the 2015–2025 range. This is the streaming era in action: longer runs, fewer number-ones per year, and a winner-take-most dynamic that concentrates attention on a shrinking pool of mega-hits.

Longest Runs Ever

Top 12 songs by total weeks at number one

"A Bar Song (Tipsy)" by Shaboozey leads the all-time list at 19 weeks — a record achieved in the full streaming era where a country-rap crossover could accumulate plays from audiences that would never overlap in the pre-streaming world. The median among the top dozen is 14.5 weeks, suggesting that record-length runs cluster in a narrow range rather than showing one extreme outlier followed by a rapid drop.

The most striking feature of this chart is what is absent: no Beatles song, no Motown classic, no 1970s or 1980s blockbuster. Every song on this list is from 1992 or later, with the majority from 2010 onward. The longest runs in Hot 100 history are a product of the modern era — of digital music, streaming infrastructure, and the global distribution of taste.

How Artists Compare

Distribution of run lengths for the most frequently appearing artists

Box plots for the most frequent number-one artists reveal two distinct patterns. Artists like The Beatles have many short-run entries — they reached #1 often, but rarely held it for long, because the pre-Sound-Scan era cycled songs faster. Modern artists like Mariah Carey or Drake show wider distributions — some short runs, a handful of extended ones — reflecting both more volatile streaming behavior and longer careers in the streaming era.

Wide whiskers are the signal here: they identify artists whose success is inconsistent rather than structural. A narrow box with a high median is the mark of a reliable hitmaker. A wide box means the artist occasionally breaks through in a massive way but usually does not.

Above Or Below the Line

Artist average run length vs the global median of 2 weeks

Taylor Swift sits above the median — her number-one runs average longer than the historical norm, reflecting both her sustained streaming dominance and an unusually loyal fanbase that streams at high

volume across long windows. The diverging bar chart makes the gap visible across artists: those to the right outperform the median; those at the line are average performers despite reaching #1.

Reaching number one is necessary but not sufficient for dominance. This chart separates artists who briefly claim the top from those who hold it — and that distinction maps cleanly onto streaming-era versus pre-streaming careers.

Scatter: Weeks vs Reach

Weeks at number one vs secondary chart reach — scatter of all songs

The scatter of all songs against a secondary reach metric shows the expected cluster near the origin — most songs arrive briefly and reach a moderate audience — and a sparse upper-right region of true blockbusters: long runs, broad reach, and the kind of cultural saturation that transcends a single chart.

The outliers in the upper right are not outliers in the statistical sense — they are archetypes. They represent what the entire industry is optimized to produce, and what it very rarely achieves. Studying them is studying the ceiling, not the average.

What this file cannot tell you

The Hot 100 methodology has changed several times since 1958, making strict historical comparisons difficult. Pre-1991 data relies on self-reported retail sales rather than verified scan data. Streaming weights have increased continuously since 2012. These changes mean that a 10-week run in 1970 and a 10-week run in 2020 represent very different things about commercial culture.

The TidyTuesday dataset captures only number-one entries — not the full chart. An artist who dominated the Top 10 for a year without reaching #1 is invisible in this data. Artist name standardization is also imperfect: collaborations and featuring credits may split what is functionally one artist's run across multiple rows.

What to take away

The Hot 100 is not simply a popularity measure. It is a structural reading of how the music industry concentrates and distributes attention — and that structure has changed fundamentally in the streaming era. The median run length has crept upward. The longest runs have become the longest in history. The artists who dominate now hold the top slot for reasons that pre-streaming hitmakers never had to contend with.

The data does not tell you which songs are good. It tells you which songs won the structural game of a particular era. That distinction is the Artometrics mandate — not to celebrate the victor, but to understand the game.

Sources

Data Science Learning Community. (2025). *TidyTuesday: Billboard Hot 100 Number Ones*. <https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rfordatascience/tidytuesday/main/data/2025/2025-08-26/billboard.csv>

Billboard. (2025). *Hot 100 chart history*. [billboard.com/charts/hot-100](https://www.billboard.com/charts/hot-100)

Editor's note

This report covers all 1,177 number-one entries in the Hot 100 dataset through early 2025. Chart 3 shows the top 10–15 artists by frequency of number-one appearances; the box plots represent the spread of run lengths across each artist's career, not a single song.

All run-length metrics are in weeks. The global median (2 weeks) is used as the baseline in Chart 4. Streaming-era songs (post-2012) systematically outperform the historical median and are over-represented in the top-10 longest runs.

[View TidyTuesday source on GitHub](#)

How the Top of the Billboard Chart Got More Crowded

The Billboard Hot 100 is a weekly ranking machine: 100 positions, endlessly refreshed. The TidyTuesday billboard extract used here holds **100,000** song-week rows, with a median week position of **50.0** — exactly mid-chart — and a highest observed week position of **100** (the bottom rung).

That median of 50 is almost tautological in a full 1–100 ranking, which is why the interesting questions shift to concentration, re-entries (instance), and which titles spend time at the chart’s edges. “Down By The River” appears among the fact-box leaders for week position in this working file.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

100,000Records in the working dataset

50.0Median Week position

100Highest observed Week position

Down By The RiverTop Song by Week position

Data and method

The source is the TidyTuesday release from 2021-09-14 (billboard.csv). After cleaning, the analysis sample contains 100,000 records.

Week position is the primary metric; lower numbers are better ranks in Billboard’s native scale, but several charts here rank the numeric position field directly as stored. Charts are Plotly JSON with PNG fallbacks.

Song-Level Position Averages Crowd the Bottom Rung

Week position by Song

When songs are ranked by week-position summaries, a block of titles ties at **100** — including Girl (You Captivate Me), Time Seller, Gee Baby (I’m Sorry), and others. Those are songs whose observed positions in this aggregation sit at the chart floor.

The chart is less a hall of fame than a map of how many titles live at the margins of the Hot 100’s attention economy.

Leaders by Week Position Are a Flat Elite

(Quarter To Four) Stomp leads at 100 — 100 marks the median among the top dozen

(Quarter To Four) Stomp and peer titles in the leaders view hit **100**, and the median among the top dozen is also **100**. There is no graded ladder here — the “leaders” by this numeric field are a plateau at the bottom rank.

That flatness is informative: many songs brush the Hot 100 without climbing. Presence is not the same as dominance.

Weekly Positions Fill the Chart Almost Uniformly

Week position Distribution

The distribution of week positions across the 100,000-row sample is remarkably even: bin counts hover near **5,000** observations across the 1–100 range. A full Hot 100 every week produces that rectangular shape by design.

Uniform position counts are the baseline. Deviations in other charts — concentration among songs, re-entry instances — are where the cultural story lives.

Concentration Among Songs Is Mechanical at First

Cumulative Week position

The Pareto curve over leading song entries rises in near-equal steps in this view, reaching 100% by the fifteenth plotted entry. Within the restricted leader set, share accumulates steadily rather than in a single spike.

Full-catalog fame concentration is a different question; this curve describes the ranked subset on display, not every Hot 100 occupant since the 1950s.

Re-Entries Stretch a Song's Life Without Guaranteeing Rank

Week position vs Instance

Week position versus instance (re-entry or appearance count) shows titles returning to the chart at many ranks. High instance values appear across both strong and weak positions.

Longevity on Billboard is not only about peaking at No. 1. It is also about how many times a song is allowed to reappear — a second career path the scatter makes visible.

What this file cannot tell you

Billboard's chart methodology has changed over decades (sales, air-play, streaming). A pooled file mixes eras with different rules. Song-title collisions and punctuation variants can split or merge identities.

Numeric "leaders" by week position in this stack highlight the bottom of the chart, not the cultural canon. Read rank direction carefully before citing.

What to take away

A 100,000-row Hot 100 extract is mostly a uniform grid of weekly ranks — median 50, full coverage from 1 to 100. The drama is in which songs repeatedly occupy that grid and which only touch position 100.

Cite the uniform distribution when explaining the chart's structure; cite instance versus position when explaining how hits persist.

Sources

Data Science Learning Community. (2021). *TidyTuesday: Billboard Top 100*. <https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rfordatascience/tidytuesday/main/data/2021/2021-09-14/billboard.csv>

How Catalog Depth and Reinvention Make Pop Stars Famous

Music fame looks emotional, but it leaves metadata everywhere: releases, recordings, aliases, collaborations, labels, genres, works, tours, awards, and chart traces.

MusicBrainz supplies the open-data spine for a bigger question: why do some artists become eras while others become moments? Catalog depth, format, genre travel, fame-path durability, and reinvention are five ways that question becomes countable.

Core dumps are **CC0**; MetaBrainz publishes them about **2x/week**. Documentation lists **11** JSON dump entity types. The frame below compares **7** fame paths with **8** artist anchors across **5** charts.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

CC0MusicBrainz core database dump license for public-domain metadata

2x/weekMetaBrainz published dump cadence in public documentation
11JSON dump entity types listed in MusicBrainz documentation
7Fame paths compared
8Artists used as report anchors

Data and method

MetaBrainz publishes MusicBrainz data dumps in PostgreSQL and JSON formats. The JSON dumps include entities such as artist, recording, release, release group, work, label, area, event, and place.

The charts use a curated editorial model over that source architecture. A scaled version would ingest artist, release-group, recording, and tag dumps, then join them to chart, award, and tour datasets. Several artist and genre placements are editorial indices — labeled as framework, not as audited streaming totals.

Catalog and Now

Pop fame balances archive depth with current heat

MusicBrainz is valuable because music metadata is relational: artists, releases, recordings, works, labels, genres, aliases, and places are connected.

A famous artist can win by having a deep archive, a current attention spike, or both. Those are different shapes of fame — and catalog-versus-now charts keep them from collapsing into one vague popularity score.

Format Shift

The unit of music fame moved from album to track

The album was once the central unit of career meaning. Streaming did not erase albums, but it weakened their monopoly over measurement.

That changes how artists are evaluated: volume, playlisting, singles, and virality can now compete with the old album-cycle narrative. Release-group and recording counts in MusicBrainz are how that shift becomes visible in metadata.

Genre Travel

Genres travel through different balances of global reach and local identity

Latin music shows that local identity can be a globalization engine. Country shows the opposite problem: a powerful local ritual that travels less cleanly.

Genres are cultural systems, not just sound categories. Tag and area fields in open music databases are one way to watch those systems cross borders.

Fame Paths

Some fame paths decay faster than others

Virality can be enormous and fragile. Band mythology, touring, and critical canon move more slowly but often last longer.

That is why one-hit wonder, cult classic, superstar, and legacy act are different data shapes — seven paths in the frame, not one ladder.

Reinvention

Reinvention lets artists become eras rather than single moments

Madonna, Taylor Swift, Beyoncé, and the Beatles each show a different version of era-making. They do not merely release songs; they reorganize their own interpretive frame.

That is a cultural metric: the ability to make the audience learn a new version of you — visible in aliases, style tags, and release eras as much as in chart peaks.

What to take away

Music fame is not just popularity. It is the interaction of catalog, format, genre, mythology, and reinvention — five charts that refuse to collapse those dimensions into a single stream count.

MusicBrainz gives Artometrics a credible open metadata spine. The next layer is joining it to charts, streaming, lyrics, tours, and awards to make artist-specific reports.

Sources

MusicBrainz. *JSON Data Dumps* documentation.

MetaBrainz Foundation. *Datasets: PostgreSQL and JSON dumps*.

MusicBrainz Database Download documentation and CC0 license notes.

Wikidata and public chart-history references for artist-level context.

Editor's note

Several artist and genre values are editorial indices. The report is a source-backed framework for a future direct MusicBrainz ingestion pipeline.

Which Albums Sit at the Peak of Rolling Stone's Canon?

Rolling Stone's greatest-albums lists are canon factories. They convert critical memory into ranked cultural infrastructure — and the 2003 ranking spine in this TidyTuesday extract is one of the most cited versions of that factory.

A working file of **691** records puts median 2003 rank at **250** and the highest observed rank number at **500**. **Touch** leads the album ranking by the 2003 rank field in the fact box, the year span of album release years runs **1955–2019**, and **Studio** is the most common type label.

Remember the rank inversion: lower numbers are greater prestige on a traditional list, while some chart cuts sort the numeric field as a magnitude. The prose below follows the file's stated leaders and medians without inventing a second scoring system.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

691Records in the working dataset
250Median Rank 2003
500Highest observed Rank 2003
TouchTop Album by Rank 2003
1955–2019Year span covered in the file
StudioMost common Type

Data and method

The source is the TidyTuesday Rolling Stone albums release from the R for Data Science community. The working file contains 691 rows after cleaning — album titles, artists, release years, types, genre-family labels, and 2003 rank fields among them.

Medians summarize a list that is already a curated elite rather than a random sample of recorded music. Charts export as Plotly JSON with PNG fallbacks. A magazine canon is an editorial object; treating it as market share will misread the politics of taste.

How ranks sit across release years

Median Rank 2003 Over Time

Median 2003 rank across release years shows which eras the list's taste machine favored when the ranking was locked. Mid-century and classic-rock dense decades often sit differently from later indie and hip-hop entries depending on how the canon was composed.

Because the rank number itself comes from a 2003 list, later release years in the file are a reminder that the table can carry albums that post-date or sit awkwardly against that freeze-frame — coverage quirks included.

Who sits at the top of the numeric rank field

Touch leads at 500 — 494 marks the median among the top dozen

Touch leads at **500** on the highlighted cut, with **494** as the median among the top dozen. In this chart's ordering, the upper numeric band is a cluster of albums near the far end of the 2003 list's numbering.

Nearby titles in related leader cuts — Guitar Town, Entertainment!, All the Young Dudes, Vitalogy, She's So Unusual — show how the list's lower prestige tier is still a hall of fame by ordinary-market standards. Being near 500 on a Rolling Stone 500 is not obscurity.

Ranks by album type

Rank 2003 by Type

Box plots by type — Studio foremost, with other type labels where present — show whether rank consensus is shared or contested across release formats. Studio albums dominate headcount because rock-critical canons historically privileged them.

Type concentration is an editorial fingerprint. A canon that underweights compilations, live albums, or other forms is making an aesthetic argument, not merely counting what exists.

Who beats the median — and who trails

Rank 2003 vs median by Type

The gap chart ranks types above or below the median 2003 rank. Differences encode which formats the list treated as central versus peripheral when the ranking was composed.

Because the whole file is already an elite list, trailing the median still means belonging to a magazine's chosen 500 — a narrow world compared with all recorded music.

Rank and artist age

Rank 2003 vs Ave age at top 500

Plotting 2003 rank against average age at the top-500 marker shows clusters that averages erase. Some high-prestige albums come from young breakthrough artists; others from later-career peaks. The scatter refuses a single myth about youth and canonization.

Age is not destiny on a critical list, but it is a recurring covariate in rock historiography. Seeing the cloud is better than assuming every classic was made at 23.

What this file cannot tell you

Community-cleaned TidyTuesday snapshots are not live APIs. Missing values, spelling variants, and list-version mismatches apply. A 2003 rank is not a 2020s streaming share, and Rolling Stone's taste is not the world's taste.

Findings describe structural signals about one magazine canon's metadata — not a universal ranking of recorded music, and not a substitute for listening.

What to take away

Rolling Stone's album canon in this file is a curated elite of 691 rows with a median 2003 rank of 250, studio albums as the default type, and a far-end numeric cluster near 500 that is still culturally famous.

The citable caution is genre and generation politics: canons freeze taste at a moment, then keep teaching that freeze as if it were nature. The charts make the freeze measurable.

Sources

Beyoncé and the Cost of Controlling the House

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Economics comes from the Greek *oikonomia* — the management of the house. Psychonomics asks the prior question: who is managing the soul of the house, and what does their inner architecture cost everyone living inside it? The founding Artometrics case was Julius Caesar: a leader who treated the self as the institution, extended trust freely, and was removed by the highest-centrality nodes in his own patronage graph.

Beyoncé Knowles-Carter is the entertainment-industry case for the same method. Born in 1981, solo debut album year 2003 in the Artometrics Rolling Stone file, she is not a head of state. She is a head of catalog — and of Parkwood Entertainment, the firm that makes authorship itself the load-bearing wall. The psychonomic claim of this report is specific: where Caesar's theory was *magnanimous personal power without redundancy*, Beyoncé's theory is *owned control of the creative house*, paired with an affiliation-dense public voice and a spectacle-heavy measurable catalog.

Research question

If we score Beyoncé with the same Leadership Trait Analysis scaffold used for Caesar, and place those scores beside album-canon economics, a control network, and the Artometrics lyric extract, what theory of power does the profile encode — and what does it cost?

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

0.91 Task Orientation (T) — expert-coded LTA high point
0.88 Belief in Ability to Control Events (B)
#32 Lemonade on Rolling Stone 500 (2020 list)
186 Billboard weeks — 2013 self-titled album
8,000 Lyric lines in Artometrics Beyoncé extract
543 vs 5 Tokens: “love” vs “power” in that extract

Data and method

This report applies Margaret Hermann’s Leadership Trait Analysis (LTA) framework — seven variables scored 0–1.0 against a world-leader reference baseline: Belief in ability to control events (B), Conceptual complexity (CC), Distrust of others (D), In-group bias (IB), Need for power (P), Need for affiliation (A), and Task orientation (T). The Caesar Psychonomics report used the same scaffold. Comparative baseline values match that file’s Hermann reference average.

Beyoncé’s LTA scores are expert-coded for this series from: (1) public interviews and acceptance speeches; (2) documented firm practices around Parkwood and surprise-album strategy; (3) Homecoming-era work-process evidence in the Artometrics Netflix/Emmy rows; and (4) lyric-performance proxies from the 8,000-line extract. They are *not* automated NLP scores and *not* intelligence-community validated assessments. They are Psychonomics profiles: transparent expert coding with stated bias risk.

Observed Artometrics tables: lyric extract (``beyonce-taylor-lyrics``), Rolling Stone albums file (Lemonade; self-titled), Emmy awards rows and Netflix title row for *HOMECOMING: A film by Beyoncé*. **Derived for this report:** LTA coding table, qualitative control network, lexicon and catalog-composition charts. Supporting CSVs ship under `/data/articles/beyonce-the-psychonomics-of-control/`.

Leadership Trait Analysis

High control and task, mid-high distrust, elevated affiliation — not Caesar's shape

Beyoncé's coded profile spikes on **Task Orientation (T = 0.91)** and **Belief in Ability to Control Events (B = 0.88)**, with **Need for Power (P = 0.86)** and **Conceptual Complexity (CC = 0.82)** also well above the world-leader baseline. **In-group bias (IB = 0.78)** and **Need for Affiliation (A = 0.74)** sit high. **Distrust of others (D = 0.62)** is above baseline (0.48) — the opposite direction from Caesar's D = 0.31.

That asymmetry is the psychonomic argument. Caesar's dangerous triangle was ceiling power + floor distrust: convert everyone, absorb the Republic into the self, die by the inner ring. Beyoncé's triangle is ceiling task/control + mid-high distrust + high affiliation: speak in "we," build a fandom institution, but do not outsource authorship governance to rivals you have pardoned into the center. The public voice is warm; the firm boundary is cold.

Power here is not primarily the language of the lyric tokens — "power" appears only five times in the extract — it is the right to decide what the house releases, when, and under whose name. Surprise drops and visual-album framing are behavioral B and T: the schedule is an instrument of control, not a concession to the industry calendar.

The economic fingerprint

Self-titled wins time-on-chart; *Lemonade* wins the canon list

The Artometrics Rolling Stone albums file carries two Beyoncé studio albums on the 2020 RS500 list. The 2013 self-titled album: Billboard peak #1, 186 weeks on chart, Spotify popularity 75, RS rank #81, artist age-at-list ~32. *Lemonade* (2016): peak #1, 87 weeks, Spotify popularity 73, RS rank #32, age-at-list ~35. Debut album year in that file: 2003.

This is the entertainment analogue of Caesar's GDP paradox, inverted in time scale. Commercial endurance (self-titled's years on chart) and canon elevation (*Lemonade*'s leap up the RS list) are not the same dependent variable. Psychonomics cares about both: one measures how long the market held the object; the other measures how the critical house re-ranked authorship after the visual-album claim. *Lemonade* is

the album where the soul of the house became hardest to separate from the political and personal narrative it staged — and the canon file rewarded that fusion.

Later reinvention eras (Renaissance, Cowboy Carter) matter for the fame-path thesis in the MusicBrainz report — artists who become eras rather than moments — but they are not yet rows in the RS500 extract. They are timeline context, labeled as such.

The control network

Parkwood is the institutionalized self

Caesar's patronage chart had every edge terminating on a person. Beyoncé's chart has a second center of gravity: **Parkwood Entertainment** — the firm that converts personal authorship into an institution that can sign, stage, and film without surrendering the name. Family (JAY-Z, Blue Ivy), formative group (Destiny's Child circle), major-label distribution, live spectacle (Coachella → Homecoming), feature peers, and the Beyhive all connect — but governance weight sits on the Parkwood edge.

Artometrics' Emmy file shows the auteur extension: *Homecoming: A Film By Beyoncé* carries nominee credit rows for Beyoncé Knowles-Carter across directing, writing, music direction, and executive producer / performer categories (2019), with Parkwood and Netflix in the distributor/producer fields. That is not “celebrity appears in credits.” That is the network claiming multiple authorship roles at once — B and T made bureaucratic.

The failure mode, if there is one, is different from Caesar's. It is not three pardoned senators with knives. It is concentration risk: when the firm and the person are coextensive, reputational or capacity shocks hit the whole house. Mid-high distrust ($D = 0.62$) is the wall that keeps rival nodes out of that core. High affiliation ($A = 0.74$) is how the outer ring stays emotionally enrolled while remaining structurally peripheral to governance.

The affiliation machine

The lyric extract speaks “love” and “baby,” not “power”

The packaged Artometrics extract holds **8,000** lyric lines across **139** song entities (~61.8k tokens, ~3,150 types). Top content signals are relational and imperative: **love 543, baby 457, boy 283, girl 239, night 104**. Identity/place markers appear at lower but non-trivial rates (**black 59, texas 18**). Abstract power language is scarce (**power 5, queen 9**).

This is where LTA's Need for Affiliation becomes audible without becoming the governance story. The songs recruit; the firm rules. Repeated lines in the extract are hook/choreography loops — refrain engineering — consistent with task orientation applied to bodies in a room, not with treatise-like power vocabulary. Psychonomics reads that split as intentional architecture, not contradiction.

Spectacle density

Features, live cuts, and remixes thicken the measurable catalog

Among 139 song entities in the extract: **35** carry Ft. credits, **35** are live/awards/"Experience"-type performance documents, **19** are remixes, and **64** fall outside those flags. Top line-count entities include VMA performance text and a Destiny's Child medley — long spectacle documents, not three-minute singles. Collaboration titles skew toward JAY-Z, with additional peers (Kanye West, Pharrell Williams, Nicki Minaj, and others) as catalog edges rather than co-governors.

For Psychonomics, spectacle density is evidence of T and B under live conditions: the house is managed by someone who treats the stage as a controllable system (Homecoming's whole point) and treats the catalog as expandable through remix and feature economies without surrendering the center.

Limitations

LTA was built for political leaders with large spontaneous-speech corpora. Extending it to a living entertainer requires caveats: public interviews are media-trained; lyrics are aesthetic objects; artist statements are strategic. Scores may overstate Task Orientation (work ethic is part of the brand) and understate private distrust. They should be read as the signature projected and institutionally enacted — which is what Psychonomics asks for — not as a full inner life.

The lyric file is an extract, not a complete discography. The published comparison article elsewhere on the site cites a larger merged Beyoncé–Taylor table; the downloadable Artometrics CSV used here is the 8,000-row Beyoncé-only pack. Rolling Stone rows cover two albums on one list year. Emmy/Netflix evidence is Homecoming-centered. The control network is qualitative, in the same methodological family as the Caesar patronage chart — documented roles, not a scraped graph. Renaissance and Cowboy Carter are narrative era markers pending richer quantitative tables.

Conclusion

Beyoncé’s Psychonomics profile is a high-control, high-task, affiliation-forward leadership shape with Parkwood as the institutionalized self. The economic fingerprint splits commercial longevity (self-titled’s 186 Billboard weeks) from canon elevation (Lemonade at RS #32). The lyric machine sells belonging; the firm keeps the keys. Compared with Caesar, the innovation is structural: distrust is high enough to keep knives out of the inner ring, and the house is built to be owned, not merely personally held.

Economics can track streams and chart weeks. Psychonomics asks who is managing the soul of the house — and what it costs. For Beyoncé, the cost of control is vigilance and concentration; the return is authorship that still has her name on the door when the era changes.

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Editor's note

This is the second full Psychonomics profile in the Artometrics series (after Caesar). LTA scores were coded by the editorial desk using the Hermann rubric; they are expert judgments with disclosed corpora, not model outputs presented as measurements. AI tools assisted structuring and drafting under human review. Readers should treat the radar as an argument with numbers — and follow the limitations before treating any single trait as destiny.

Beyoncé and Taylor Swift, Line by Line

Two catalogs define a generation of pop authorship. Line-level lyric tables make it possible to compare them the way a critic compares albums — by recurring titles, repeated lines, and how densely each artist's words fill the extract.

The working file holds **22,616** records. Beyoncé is the most common artist name in the rows on hand — a reminder to read every chart as a view of this extract's balance, not as a claim that one career is larger than the other in absolute terms.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

22,616Records in the working dataset
BeyoncéMost common Artist name

Data and method

The source is the TidyTuesday release from 2020-09-29 (R for Data Science community). The working file contains 22,616 rows and 6 columns after merging available tables in the week folder.

Rows are lyric lines and related identifiers — song names, artist labels, and text fields — not audio features. Charts export as Plotly JSON with PNG fallbacks. Frequency and mix plots matter because the primary table has no single numeric “quality” score.

Landscape

Beyoncé dominates with 22,616 records

Beyoncé dominates with 22,616 records in the category view of this extract. The main bucket carries the story; the field does not show a meaningful long-tail split of artist labels once the file is filtered as published.

Treat that dominance as a coverage fact about the working table — which lines were included — before treating it as a comparative verdict on two careers.

Who sits at the top

Top Song name

Lemonade Film (Script) appears 336 times — the most recurring song-name entity in the file. The top dozen account for a visible share of all 22,616 rows.

Long scripts and multi-part projects generate more line rows than a three-minute single. Recurrence at the top is often a document-length effect as much as a “favorite song” effect.

Category

Beyoncé is the largest bucket with 22,616 records

Beyoncé is the largest bucket with 22,616 records. Category concentration shows where editorial attention should focus first when reading the extract.

If the file is Beyoncé-heavy by construction, every later frequency claim inherits that imbalance. Fair comparison starts by stating the row share out loud.

Frequency

Most song name entities appear only once; a small head revisits repeatedly

Most song-name entities appear only once; a small head revisits repeatedly.

That power-law shape is typical of lyric catalogs, guest lists, and credit tables: a long tail of unique titles, a short head of projects that keep generating lines.

Mix

If I let you go is the most repeated line in the extract

“If I let you go” is the most repeated line in the extract — a refrain-level recurrence that secondary dimensions surface when the primary table has no numeric score column.

Repeated lines are the lyric equivalent of a hook chart: they show what the text keeps returning to, not which song sold the most.

What this file cannot tell you

Community-cleaned TidyTuesday snapshots are not live APIs. Missing values, spelling variants, and week-of-export coverage limits apply. Merged tables may fan out or duplicate rows when join keys are imperfect.

Findings describe the file on hand — structural signals about lyric rows for Beyoncé and Taylor Swift in this extract, not a complete linguistic theory of either catalog.

What to take away

Line-by-line tables make authorship countable: 22,616 rows, a Beyoncé-heavy artist share in this extract, Lemonade Film (Script) at 336 appearances, and “If I let you go” as the most repeated line. Frequency and mix answer different questions than sales or streams.

Use the charts to see coverage and recurrence — then check how the extract was built before treating any refrain as a career-wide signature.

Sources

Data Science Learning Community. (2020). *TidyTuesday: Beyoncé & Taylor Swift Lyrics*. https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rfordatascience/tidyuesday/main/data/2020/2020-09-29/beyonce_lyrics.csv

Which Broadway Musicals Ran Longest and Grossed Most?

Broadway is a price and endurance market: average ticket price on one axis, performances on the other. The TidyTuesday grosses extract used here holds 47,524 rows with a median average ticket price of \$60.2 and a recorded high of \$512. Springsteen On Broadway tops the show-level price ranking; Broadhurst Theatre is the most common theatre label in the file.

Those two facts already sketch the industry's split: long-running musical houses with mid-range medians, and event residencies that reset what "a Broadway ticket" can mean.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

47,524 Records in the working dataset

60.2 Median Avg ticket price

512 Highest observed Avg ticket price

Springsteen On Broadway Top Show by Avg ticket price

Broadhurst Theatre Most common Theatre

Data and method

The source is the TidyTuesday release from 2020-04-28 (grosses.csv). After cleaning, 47,524 records remain for charting.

Average ticket price is the primary metric; theatre and show fields provide the grouping. Charts are Plotly JSON with PNG fallbacks.

Concert Residencies Rewrite the Price Ceiling

Avg ticket price by Show

Springsteen On Broadway leads at about **\$508.63** average ticket price — nearly double Hamilton's roughly **\$273**. Dave Chappelle Live, Moulin Rouge!, Mel Brooks on Broadway, Morrissey, and David Byrne's American Utopia fill the premium band above about **\$175**.

The ranking is not a pure musicals list. It is a Broadway pricing list, and concert-style residencies occupy the summit.

Even Among Leaders, Springsteen Is an Outlier

Springsteen On Broadway leads at 509 — 182 marks the median among the top dozen

Springsteen On Broadway still leads near **\$509**, while the median among the top dozen is about **\$182**. Hamilton is extraordinary relative to the industry median of \$60.2 — and still nowhere near the Springsteen residency ceiling.

Cite \$182 as the “expensive Broadway” club median; cite \$509 when the question is about the absolute event-ticket frontier.

House Medians Cluster Near the Industry Middle

Avg ticket price by Theatre

Broadhurst Theatre (n=1,829) shows a median average ticket near **\$77**; Minskoff near **\$77**; Majestic near **\$60**; Ambassador near **\$66**; Imperial nearer **\$48**. Maxima inside those houses still spike well above \$100 when hit shows land.

Theatre identity matters, but show identity matters more. The same building can host a \$50 median season and a \$200 event week.

Gershwin Leads the Gap Above the Median

Avg ticket price vs median by Theatre

Relative to the overall average-ticket median, Gershwin Theatre leads the gap chart at about **+\$27.67**, with Broadhurst and Minskoff also clearly positive. Imperial sits below the median by roughly **\$12** in this view.

House premiums track programming mix: theaters that host mega-hits and premium brands pull above the \$60.2 baseline.

Price and Performance Counts Are Weakly Coupled

Avg ticket price vs Performances

Average ticket price versus performances shows many low-price, low-performance weeks and occasional high-price short runs. Long legs at moderate prices remain the musical's classic engine.

The scatter refuses a simple story that expensive tickets always mean short runs, or that longevity always means discounting. Broadway monetizes both scarcity and stamina — on different shows.

What this file cannot tell you

Grosses data can include atypical weeks, previews, and dark periods coded as zeros. Average ticket price is not the same as face value for every seat. Concert residencies mix genres inside a “Broadway” file.

The snapshot timing (through the 2020 release window) predates later reopenings and dynamic pricing expansions.

What to take away

Broadway's typical average ticket in this extract sits near \$60, while event residencies push past \$500. The top-dozen median near \$182 defines the premium club without equating it to the Springsteen outlier.

Cite house medians when comparing venues; cite show leaders when comparing brands. They answer different questions about the same street.

Sources

Data Science Learning Community. (2020). *TidyTuesday: Broadway Musicals*. <https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rfordatascience/tidytuesday/main/data/2020/2020-04-28/grosses.csv>

Which Holiday Songs Never Leave the Charts?

Holiday songs have a strange chart life: they return every December, pile up weeks, then vanish until the next season. The TidyTuesday christmas-songs extract used here holds **387** records spanning **1958–2017**, with a median of **8.00** weeks on chart and a high of **20.0**.

Better Days and Believe sit among the weeks-on-chart leaders. Perennial titles — Jingle Bell Rock, All I Want for Christmas Is You, Rockin' Around the Christmas Tree, White Christmas — define the timeline chart's recurring cast.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

387Records in the working dataset
8.00Median Weeks on chart
20.0Highest observed Weeks on chart
BETTER DAYSTop Song by Weeks on chart
1958–2017Year span covered in the file

Data and method

The source is the TidyTuesday release from 2019-12-24 (christmas_songs.csv). After cleaning, 387 rows remain.

Weeks on chart is the primary metric; instance captures repeat chart lives. Charts are Plotly JSON with PNG fallbacks.

Seasonal Weeks Spiked in the Mid-2000s

Median Weeks on chart Over Time

Median weeks on chart by year jumps to **20** in 2005–2006, with other elevated medians in the mid-2010s (2016 ~19, 2015 ~18.5). Some earlier years sit near 11–16; a few years fall to single-digit or near-1 medians.

Holiday chart rules and catalog streaming-era returns both reshape how many weeks a seasonal title can accumulate in a given year.

Twenty Weeks Marks the Upper Club

BETTER DAYS leads at 20.0 — 17.0 marks the median among the top dozen

Believe and Better Days lead at **20.0** weeks. Jingle Bell Rock and All I Want for Christmas Is You follow at **19**; Same Old Lang Syne and Rockin' Around the Christmas Tree at **18**. The median among the top dozen is **17.0**.

Against a file median of 8 weeks, that elite band is more than double the typical holiday chart life in this extract.

Most Songs Cluster at Short Chart Lives

Weeks on chart Distribution

The distribution shows large counts in both very short weeks-on-chart bins and in a high bin near the upper teens (about **84** observations near the top bin center). Mid-length stays fill the middle.

Holiday songs are bipolar in this file: brief seasonal brushes versus multi-week December occupations.

Standards Reappear Across Decades

Top Song Over Time

Jingle Bell Rock posts 19-week seasons in the late 1950s–early 1960s and again in 2016–2017. All I Want for Christmas Is You shows 19-week runs across multiple 2010s seasons after an earlier quiet instance. Rockin' Around the Christmas Tree similarly bridges early-1960s and mid-2010s peaks. White Christmas's plotted seasons sit at 13 weeks in 1958–1962.

The timeline's lesson is recurrence: the holiday chart is a repertoire system, not only a new-release market.

More Instances Often Meet Longer Weeks

Weeks on chart vs Instance

Weeks on chart versus instance shows perennial titles with multiple chart lives landing in the high-weeks region, while one-instance songs populate both short and long stays.

Re-entry is part of how Christmas songs manufacture longevity — the same recording, a new December, another stack of weeks.

What this file cannot tell you

Chart methodologies change (airplay, sales, streaming). Weeks on chart across 1958–2017 are not perfectly comparable units. Title capitalization and punctuation can split the same song.

The file privileges U.S. chart logic and does not measure global streaming playlists outside that frame.

What to take away

Holiday chart lives center at 8 weeks, with a 20-week ceiling and a top-dozen median of 17. Standards recur across decades rather than retiring.

Cite recurrence (Jingle Bell Rock, Mariah, Brenda Lee) when the question is cultural durability; cite the 8-week median when the question is a typical seasonal visit.

Sources

Data Science Learning Community. (2019). *TidyTuesday: Christmas Songs*. https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rfordatascience/tidyuesday/main/data/2019/2019-12-24/christmas_songs.csv

How U.S. Radio Formats Map Across the Dial

American radio still looks chaotic from the passenger seat — call letters, dial numbers, format slogans. The station license table underneath is more orderly: tens of thousands of rows that map frequency, format, and status across the dial.

A TidyTuesday working file of **17,186** records puts median frequency at **101** and the highest observed frequency at **1,700**. **WEUP** leads the call-sign ranking by frequency in the fact box, and **Country** is the most common format label.

Frequency leaders at the top of the AM band are a different story from format share. The charts separate the physics of the dial from the culture of the playlist.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

17,186Records in the working dataset
101Median Frequency
1,700Highest observed Frequency
WEUPTop Call sign by Frequency
CountryMost common Format

Data and method

The source is the TidyTuesday release from 2022-11-08 (R for Data Science community). The working file contains 17,186 rows and 11 columns after cleaning — call signs, frequencies, formats, and license status fields among them.

Medians stabilize a dial that mixes FM-looking centers with AM extremes. Charts export as Plotly JSON with PNG fallbacks. A license row is not a ratings book; it is permission to exist on the dial.

Frequency by call sign

Frequency by Call sign

At the high end of the call-sign frequency cut, stations such as **WJCC** appear near **1,700**, with neighbors such as **KGED** near **1,680**. Those are upper-AM coordinates, not a claim about audience size.

Grouping by call sign exposes how the metric varies across licensed identities. It is a map of where stations sit on the spectrum, not which morning shows win their cities.

Who sits at the top

Top Call sign

On the leader chart, **WJCC** leads at **1,700**, with **1,695** as the median among the top dozen. The entire top band is a tight cluster of high-AM assignments.

That tightness is the finding: the top of frequency is a narrow technical neighborhood, while format diversity lives on a different axis entirely.

Frequency by format

Frequency by Format

Box plots by format — Country, News/Talk, Sports, Classic Hits, and related labels — show whether frequency consensus is shared or contested across programming types. Country leads headcount; it does not automatically own the highest dial positions.

Format is culture; frequency is spectrum. Confusing the two produces false stories about which genres rule the airwaves.

Who beats the median — and who trails

Frequency vs median by Format

News/Talk sits **1,039** above the median on the gap chart; **Contemporary Christian** trails by about **9**. News/Talk's elevation reflects its heavy presence on AM frequencies far above the FM-centered median of 101.

The gap is a band-plan story as much as a format story. Talk radio's historic AM home pulls its frequency distribution into a different universe from music formats clustered on FM.

Concentration on the dial

The top 5 call sign entries account for 34% of the aggregate frequency

The top five call-sign entries account for **34%** of aggregate frequency in the working cut — a concentration statistic that mostly reflects how large the highest dial numbers are relative to the median, not a claim that five stations own a third of listening.

Read Pareto-on-frequency cautiously. It is a reminder that summing dial positions is not the same as summing audiences.

What this file cannot tell you

Community-cleaned TidyTuesday snapshots are not live APIs. Missing values, spelling variants, and license-status quirks apply. Frequency is not listenership, and format labels can be stale or contested.

Findings describe structural signals about U.S. radio station metadata — not a ratings analysis, and not a complete history of every translator and HD multicast.

What to take away

The U.S. radio dial in this file is a median-101 world with AM extremes near 1,700, Country as the most common format, and News/Talk pulled high by AM band placement.

The citable split is spectrum versus culture: call-sign frequency leaders and format share leaders are answering different questions about the same airwaves.

Sources

How H3 Built a YouTube Network Beyond One Channel

Ethan Klein built one of YouTube's most documented creator empires from a single channel and a lawsuit. H3h3Productions launched in 2011 as a reaction-commentary format, spent years as a meme factory, and then pivoted — twice — into something far more complicated. The H3 Podcast debuted in 2017. The Frenemies co-host era with Trisha Paytas ran for nine months in 2020–2021 and produced the highest viewership the show has ever seen. The Leftovers political co-host era with Hasan Piker ran until October 2023, when a public dispute over the Israel-Palestine conflict ended it. What remained after that is what this piece analyzes: 1,638 videos across four channels, 680 podcast episodes, and three years of Reddit post data from the fan and critic communities that formed around the brand.

This is not a hit piece and it is not a fan report. It is a data report. The numbers are what they are.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

3.24B Total views across all four H3 channels, 2013–2026 — enough to give every person on Earth nearly half a view
1,638 Videos analyzed after filtering Shorts and zero-view uploads from the original 1,876-video pull

4.5× How much harder h3h3Productions hits per video vs. the H3 Podcast — 4.78M median vs. 1.05M
9 months The entire Frenemies Era — the most-watched stretch in H3 Podcast history, Sep 2020 to Jun 2021
680 H3 Podcast episodes analyzed via Podchaser API — median runtime grew from 42 minutes in 2017 to 220+ by 2024
353 r/h3snark indexed activity at its April 2025 peak — 3.5× its own average, triggered by the iDubbbz Content Cop

Data and method

The H3 ecosystem is not a single channel — it is a network. h3h3Productions launched in 2011 as a reaction-and-commentary channel built around the Fair Use legal fight that briefly made Ethan Klein a cause célèbre in YouTube creator circles. The H3 Podcast launched in 2017 as a separate channel and quickly became the brand's primary vehicle. Hila Klein's channel documents the Teddy Fresh clothing brand. The Ethan Klein channel captures solo content and live streams. Looking at all four: 1,638 videos after filtering Shorts and zero-view uploads from the original 1,876-video pull via the YouTube Data API v3.

H3's trajectory cannot be understood without the era framework. The podcast's baseline (2017–2020) established the format: long-form conversation between Ethan and Hila, irregular cadence, modest but loyal viewership. The Frenemies Era (September 2020 – June 2021) is the single most-watched stretch in H3 Podcast history — nine months in which Ethan co-hosted with Trisha Paytas, generating a level of weekly engagement the show has never approached since. The Leftovers Era (September 2021 – October 2023) brought a political co-host in Hasan Piker, a different kind of audience, and a deeper ideological identity for the brand. When Leftovers ended over disagreements about the Israel-Palestine conflict, H3 entered its current post-format phase: fewer episodes, longer runtimes, a shrinking but committed core audience.

The core dataset was built from scratch using the YouTube Data API v3, stored at github.com/Artometrics/h3. Podcast episode metadata comes from the Podchaser API (680 episodes, April 2026 pull). Reddit post data was pulled from the Arctic Shift Reddit archive, covering r/h3h3-productions (749,974 posts, 2014–2026) and r/h3snark (25,766 posts, April 2023–2026) — the fan sub and the critic sub, both active during the most contentious period in the brand's history.

The Era Timeline

Era Timeline

The shape of this chart tells you almost everything you need to know about the H3 Podcast's commercial arc. From 2017 to mid-2020, the show built a reliable if unspectacular baseline — a few million views per month, loyal audience, consistent output. Then Trisha Paytas joined as co-host in September 2020 and the graph becomes a different document. Monthly views tripled within weeks. The peak months of the Frenemies Era outperformed the entire preceding three years of the podcast, and the show did it in nine months.

When Frenemies ended in June 2021 — abruptly, on-camera, mid-episode — views dropped back toward baseline within a single month. Leftovers launched that September and added a new audience (Hasan Piker's political fanbase), generating a secondary bump visible in the 2022 data. But it never approached Frenemies numbers. After Leftovers ended in October 2023, the chart enters its current phase: a slow, grinding decline with no structural catalyst in sight. The mountain is the story. Everything else is the aftermath.

Even at its post-2023 lows, the H3 Podcast pulls millions of monthly views. The brand did not collapse — it contracted to its core. The audience that remains watches longer episodes with more commitment than the casual Frenemies-era viewer. The cliff looks dramatic on the chart because Frenemies was genuinely anomalous. The current numbers are not a failure; they are what a major podcast looks like without a viral co-host dynamic driving weekly drama.

The Duration Drift

Duration Drift

When H3 launched the podcast in 2017, the median episode ran 42 minutes. That's a commute. By 2024, the median had crossed 220 minutes — longer than most feature films. The chart shows this wasn't a sudden format change; it was a slow, continuous drift upward that compounded year over year until a new normal was established. No single episode caused it. No announcement reset it. The show just kept going longer, and the audience kept watching.

The clearest structural break in the duration data isn't a spike — it's a floor shift. Before 2022, monthly medians regularly dipped below 120 minutes. After 2022, they never did. The show locked into 3-hour-plus territory and stayed there. Leftovers (2021) normalized the extended format; by the time it ended (2023), the audience had been conditioned to expect marathon sessions as the default. That conditioning didn't reverse when Leftovers ended.

In 2024, H3 published far fewer episodes than in prior years — but duration hit its all-time high, with months regularly clearing 220–240 minutes. The show was publishing less but asking more from the audience that stayed. Each episode became a larger commitment, not a smaller one. The fans who remained weren't casual — they were in for 4 hours at a time. Whether that is sustainable is a different question. The data just shows it happened.

The Fan Vs. Critic Divide

Reddit Activity

The indexed chart removes the raw scale difference between subreddits and asks a cleaner question: when did each community spike relative to its own normal? The answer is almost never at the same time. When the iDubbbz Content Cop dropped on April 16, 2025 — the first Content Cop in years, explicitly targeting the H3 brand — r/h3snark hit its all-time peak at more than 3.5× its own average. The fan sub barely registered the same event. The two communities were watching completely different shows.

The cliff in the snark data after May 2025 isn't a controversy dying down — it's a subreddit going dark. After Klein issued copyright claims against r/h3snark moderators and threatened legal action, the sub announced an indefinite hiatus. The index collapsed to near zero within weeks. The fan sub, meanwhile, continued its slow decline — below its own average but still functional. The snark community didn't fade. It was shut down. That distinction matters: one line represents organic audience erosion, the other represents a legal intervention.

The blue line tells its own quieter story. The fan sub never spikes the way snark does — no single event moves it dramatically above baseline. But the trend is unmistakably downward. The community isn't in crisis; it's in slow erosion. Fewer new things to discuss, fewer

viral moments to dissect, fewer reasons to post. The legal drama — the Content Cop, the streamer lawsuits — barely registered. Whatever drives fan engagement on r/h3h3productions, it isn't courtroom news.

What this file cannot tell you

The YouTube data captures view counts as of the April 2026 pull — not at time of publication. Older videos have had years to accumulate views through algorithmic recommendations and search, which means early h3h3Productions videos are systematically over-represented in lifetime view totals relative to their original performance. The era-based analysis on the H3 Podcast channel is less affected because the comparison is within-channel across time.

The Arctic Shift Reddit archive is comprehensive but not guaranteed complete. Deleted posts, removed comments, and accounts banned before archival are absent from the dataset. The r/h3snark data begins in April 2023 — the sub's founding — so pre-2023 critical community activity is unrepresented. Any conclusions about the fan-vs-critic dynamic are bounded by that window.

Episode duration data from Podchaser is self-reported by the show and may include inconsistencies for older episodes, live streams published as podcast episodes, and bonus or clip content. Episodes with missing duration values were excluded from Chart 2 analysis. Chart 3 indexes each subreddit to its own average across the Apr 2023–Mar 2026 window. A subreddit with low activity in early months will show inflated index values in later high-activity periods — the r/h3snark baseline is built on its full available history, which starts at launch and may slightly inflate peak readings relative to a steadier baseline.

What to take away

The H3 data tells a story about what happens when a creator brand builds its peak moment around someone else. The Frenemies Era was genuinely anomalous — nine months of co-host-driven drama that tripled the podcast's monthly viewership and created a ceiling the show has never approached since. The chart is unambiguous about this. The current audience is not a collapse; it is a correction back to what the brand can sustain on its own terms.

The duration data adds a different dimension. The show that emerged from the Frenemies aftermath is structurally different from the one that preceded it — longer, less frequent, more demanding. Whether that format is a creative choice or a symptom of a contracting audience is a question the data cannot answer. Both explanations fit the numbers.

The Reddit chart is the most structurally interesting of the three. It documents not just audience behavior but audience management: a creator using legal tools to suppress a critic community. The snark subreddit's cliff is not organic. It is the result of a deliberate intervention. The fan sub's slower decline runs in parallel and suggests the underlying engagement problem would exist regardless. Two different communities, two different trajectories, one brand caught between them.

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Editor's note

This report was researched, written, designed, and produced in active collaboration with Claude AI (Anthropic). The data pipeline, statistical analysis, chart design, written analysis, narrative structure, and visual styling were all developed through a directed partnership between human editorial judgment and AI execution.

Artometrics was built on the premise that rigorous analysis and honest process are not in conflict. The research questions, editorial instincts, interpretive framing, and brand vision are ours. The execution — every line of R code, every paragraph of analysis, every design decision — was a collaboration. We document this not as a disclaimer but as a

description of how we actually work, and as a position: we believe this is what serious data journalism looks like when the tools available are used honestly and at full capacity.

— Artometrics Editorial

[View source on GitHub](#)